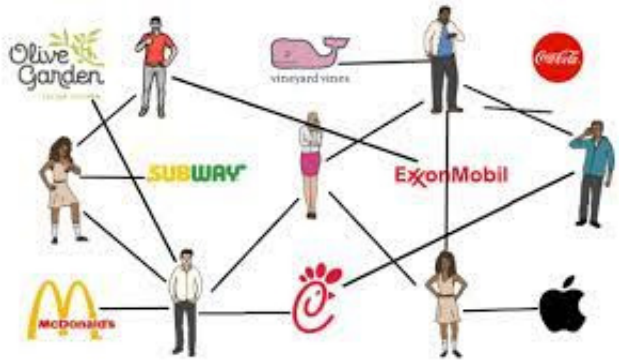
Mina is also a fan of fast, secure, and cost-effective transactions, so she decided to use Lightning for her purchases at McDonald's. With Lightning, she can enjoy her meals even more knowing that her payments are processed instantly, securely, and with low fees. Plus, since the Lightning Network provides financial inclusion, Mina can now pay for her meals even if she is in a remote area in El Salvador.

To get started with Lightning, Mina first downloads a Lightning Wallet on her phone. She then funds her Lightning Wallet by sending some bitcoin from her regular bitcoin wallet to her new Lightning Wallet. This process is called "funding the wallet" or "funding a payment channel." Mina can fund her wallet with any amount of bitcoin she is comfortable with, but it's important to note that the amount of bitcoin she locks in her Lightning Wallet cannot be used in her on-chain transactions.

Once her Lightning Wallet is funded, she can use it to make payments to McDonald's. McDonald's has a Lightning Node, so Mina can open a payment channel with them by sending some of her bitcoin from her Lightning Wallet to a specific address provided by McDonald's. This moves her ***bitcoin*** from the Bitcoin blockchain to an off-chain transaction on the Lightning Network.



With the payment channel open, Mina can now make purchases at McDonald's without having to open a new channel or pay high fees each time. The channel stays open as long as both Mina and McDonald's want to use it. For example, if Mina buys a hamburger for 0.0005 ***bitcoin***, the channel tracks that Mina now has 0.9995 ***bitcoin***. And if she buys a milkshake for 0.0003 ***bitcoin*** the next day, the channel tracks that Mina now has 0.9992 ***bitcoin***.

When Mina decides she wants to use her ***bitcoin*** balance for something else, she closes the channel by broadcasting a closing transaction to the ***Bitcoin*** *blockchain*. This is done by initiating a closing transaction in her Lightning Wallet, and the transaction contains the final balance of the channel agreed to by both parties. The transaction is then broadcast to the ***Bitcoin*** *blockchain* and confirmed by a miner. Once the transaction is confirmed, the channel is closed, and the remaining ***bitcoin*** in the channel will be returned back to Mina and McDonald's.

It's important to note that closing a channel can take some time to be confirmed on the *blockchain*. During this waiting period, the funds are still locked in the channel and cannot be used for on-chain transactions. Mina will receive a notification once the closing transaction is confirmed.